

August 20, 2026

BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina  
Provider Appeals Department  
P.O. Box 100300  
Columbia, SC 29202

**RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Violet Gerhold (MRN MUSC6365069), Claim MUSC-9D0C-4**

|                          |                                                                               |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Patient</b>           | Violet Gerhold (DOB 2017-02-25)                                               |
| <b>MRN</b>               | MUSC6365069                                                                   |
| <b>Member ID / Group</b> | BCB657213008 / GRP-77365                                                      |
| <b>Claim number</b>      | MUSC-9D0C-4                                                                   |
| <b>Date of service</b>   | 2026-06-13                                                                    |
| <b>Procedure billed</b>  | CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity |
| <b>Primary diagnosis</b> | J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified                        |
| <b>Denied amount</b>     | \$730.25                                                                      |
| <b>Denial code</b>       | CARC 11 / RARC M64 — The diagnosis is inconsistent with the procedure.        |
| <b>Appeal deadline</b>   | 2026-10-20                                                                    |

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

**SUMMARY OF APPEAL**

MUSC Health Florence Medical Center submits this formal first-level reconsideration on behalf of patient Violet Gerhold (MRN: MUSC6365069, Member ID: BCB657213008, Group: GRP-77365) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-9D0C-4 for services rendered on June 13, 2026. The claim was submitted on June 23, 2026, and denied on July 22, 2026, under CARC 11 ("The diagnosis is inconsistent with the procedure") and RARC M64 ("Missing/incomplete/invalid other diagnosis"), with the payer remark stating: "The diagnosis code reported does not support the procedure billed." MUSC Health respectfully disputes this determination and requests full reprocessing and payment of the claim.

**CLINICAL BACKGROUND**

Violet Gerhold is a nine-year-old established female patient who presented on June 13, 2026, at MUSC Health Florence Medical Center, an on-campus outpatient hospital facility. The encounter was managed by rendering provider Robert K. Lindqvist, MD (NPI: 1314059687). The primary diagnosis documented and submitted on the claim is J06.9, Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified. Two units of CPT 99214, representing an office and outpatient evaluation and management visit for an established patient with moderate complexity medical decision-making, were billed under revenue code 0510, with a total billed amount of \$730.25. The payer calculated an allowed amount of \$492.40 but remitted zero payment.

## **BASIS FOR APPEAL**

The denial rests on the assertion that diagnosis code J06.9 does not support the procedure billed. MUSC Health respectfully disagrees. CPT 99214 describes an office or outpatient evaluation and management service for an established patient requiring moderate complexity medical decision-making or a medically appropriate history and examination. Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified (J06.9), is a well-recognized acute illness that routinely necessitates a clinician's assessment of symptom severity, consideration of differential diagnoses, review of treatment options, and determination of the appropriate level of care — all elements consistent with moderate complexity decision-making. There is no CPT or ICD-10-CM coding guideline that excludes or restricts J06.9 from serving as a supporting diagnosis for 99214. The level of service is determined by the complexity of the encounter documentation, not by the category of the diagnosis alone.

Regarding RARC M64, the claim as submitted included the primary diagnosis of J06.9. To the extent the payer requires additional diagnostic specificity or secondary diagnosis codes to validate the level of service, MUSC Health is prepared to provide the complete encounter documentation, including the physician's clinical notes, for review. The medical record will substantiate the complexity of the visit and the medical necessity of the service as billed. MUSC Health requests that BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina conduct a clinical review of the submitted documentation prior to issuing any final determination, consistent with its obligations under applicable appeal and prompt-pay requirements.

## **REQUESTED ACTION**

MUSC Health respectfully requests that BlueCross BlueShield of South Carolina overturn the denial of Claim MUSC-9D0C-4, reprocess the claim in accordance with the contracted allowed amount of \$492.40, and issue payment accordingly. Supporting medical records for the June 13, 2026 encounter are attached to this reconsideration, submitted through My Insurance Manager (MIM) as directed on the remittance advice. Should additional clinical information be required, please contact the MUSC Health Revenue Cycle Appeals team promptly so that any outstanding items may be resolved within the appeal window, which closes October 20, 2026.

Respectfully submitted,

**Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC**

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## **Enclosures**

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record